Nicolás A. ORTEGA RODRÍGUEZ

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Education

Ph.D. Student in Economics — *Pontificia Universidad Javeriana / KU Leuven*
Bogotá, Colombia / Leuven, Belgium — *2025–present*

Research interests: migration, education, social protection, inequality, and development. *Advisors:* Gloria Bernal and Kristof De Witte.

M.Sc. (M2) in Development Economics — *Université Paris 1 Panthéon–Sorbonne*
Paris, France — *2024–2025*

Thesis: "The Tone of Solidarity: Race, Colorism, and Attitudes Toward Redistribution in Colombia in Times of Migration." *Supervisors:* Hillel Rapoport and Clément Gorin.

M.Sc. (M2) in Public Policy — *Université Paris 1 Panthéon–Sorbonne*
Paris, France — *2020–2021*

Thesis: "Changing the Tax Structure to Reduce Income Inequality in Colombia: A Microsimulation Model." *Supervisor:* Elvire Guillaud and David Rodriguez.

M.Sc. in Economics — *Pontificia Universidad Javeriana*
Bogotá, Colombia — *2019–2021*

B.Sc. in Economics — *Pontificia Universidad Javeriana*
Bogotá, Colombia — *2014–2019*

Research and Policy Experience

Research Fellow — *Laboratory of Economics of Education (LEE), Pontificia Universidad Javeriana*
Bogotá, Colombia — *Jan. 2026–present*

- Review academic literature and contribute to the methodological design of research projects.
- Assist in the preparation of scientific articles, research reports, and public policy documents.
- Apply econometric methods and quantitative analysis to evaluate education policies and interventions.
- Develop longitudinal databases and construct indicators to track educational outcomes.
- Manage, clean, integrate, and analyze administrative databases and large-scale education surveys.
- Contribute to ongoing research on the effects of displacement and conflict on education in Colombia.

Junior Policy Analyst – Mission-Oriented Innovation Policy — *OECD, Directorate for Science, Technology and Innovation*
Paris, France — *Jul.–Dec. 2025*

- Contributed to the update of the OECD Mission-Oriented Innovation Policy (MOIP) Online Toolkit, integrating new evidence and case studies to support member countries.
- Supported research on mission-oriented innovation policies, focusing on implementation through universities and innovation agencies.
- Conducted desk research and interviews with OECD member countries to inform policy recommendations and cross-country comparisons.
- Developed case studies and contributed to policy briefs and working papers on governance, implementation, and evaluation frameworks.

Consultant Country Economist – Haiti — *Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)*
Washington, DC, United States (remote) — *Jan.–Jul. 2025*

- Conducted research on migration using Google Trends search data to develop nowcasting models of migration flows from Haiti to different destinations, exploring alternative time-series modelling techniques.
- Supported economic analysis of Haiti as a fragile state, providing inputs on macroeconomic stability and poverty

reduction strategies.

- Conducted macroeconomic assessments of GDP, fiscal developments, and monetary conditions to evaluate economic performance and risks.
- Drafted and consolidated country economic updates to inform development projects aligned with government priorities and the IDB's country strategy.
- Collaborated with national institutions to strengthen statistical capacity and develop policy recommendations.
- Analyzed poverty, extreme poverty, and inequality trends using large datasets and statistical R and Stata.

CSTP Delegate for Colombia / OECD Affairs Manager — *Ministry of Science, Technology and Innovation, Republic of Colombia*
Bogotá, Colombia — *Jan.–Sep. 2024*

- Represented Colombia in OECD science and technology bodies, including TIP, GSF, NESTI, and BNCT, in Paris, France.
- Supported the Office of the Minister in identifying opportunities for cooperation with the OECD in science, technology, and innovation.
- Coordinated cooperation through Colombia–OECD programmes and committees involving public institutions, universities, research centres, and private-sector actors.
- Strengthened existing bilateral and multilateral cooperation programmes and engagement with the OECD.
- Contributed to updating Colombia's strategy for the internationalization of science, technology, innovation, and diplomacy, strengthening links between the Ministry and the OECD.
- Promoted further bilateral and multilateral cooperation initiatives within OECD programmes and forums.

Statistician / Policy Analyst – International Migration — *OECD, Directorate for Employment, Labour and Social Affairs*
Paris, France — *Jan.–Dec. 2022*

- Contributed to the preparation and launch of the *International Migration Outlook 2022*, supporting analysis of migration policies and trends in member and non-member countries; consolidated statistical reviews and revised published labour-market annexes and indicators.
- Analyzed labour-market outcomes in coordination with national statistical offices, examining differences across population groups for published outputs.
- Developed and implemented an updated methodology for employment, unemployment, and labour-force participation rates using EU–Eurostat data; drafted country migration notes in coordination with statistical institutions and national offices across approximately 40 countries.
- Led an early initiative to collect statistical information on Ukrainian refugees, working with international and national institutions, including IMI and IOM, on housing, migrant inflows, and visa permits.
- Processed and harmonized complex administrative datasets, microdata, migration flows and stocks, and surveys from OECD countries using R and Stata; collaborated with statisticians and economists to produce indicators and analysis.

Policy Researcher – Jobs and Income Division — *OECD, Directorate for Employment, Labour and Social Affairs*
Paris, France — *Jul. 2021–Dec. 2022*

- Managed research on geographic inequality and access to social programmes in OECD member countries, with detailed work on the United States, the United Kingdom, Spain, and Sweden; collaborated with a multidisciplinary team to develop a comparative microdata database of social programmes.
- Contributed to documentation of data sources, limitations, breaks in series, and underlying policy reforms across 15 countries.
- Oversaw the preparation of results and empirical analysis, comparing the characteristics of 20 social programmes across subnational regions.

Data / Policy Analyst — *Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Development*
Bogotá, Colombia — *Jul.–Nov. 2020*

- Developed and refined econometric forecasting models for agricultural commodities, including potatoes, rice, corn, and soybeans.
- Advised two investors and traders operating in the Chicago Board of Trade (CBOT) and the Colombia Stock Exchange (BVC).

Name Screening / Risk Analyst – AML/CFT *Scotiabank GBS*
Bogotá, Colombia *Jan.–Sep. 2019*

- Conducted politically exposed person screening and AML/CFT compliance analysis for Latin America; supported reviews related to money laundering and sustainable finance through new guidance and measurable protocols.
- Developed performance metrics comparing the Colombian division with other Latin American teams and presented results to senior executives in Canada.

Economic Research Intern – Economic Research Unit *Banco de la República (Central Bank of Colombia)*
Bogotá, Colombia *Jan.–Dec. 2018*

- Produced research reports on industrial performance and business taxation in Colombia; compared econometric methodologies for estimating effective tax rates and examining tax burdens on consumers, workers, and capital.
- Calculated and compared growth rates and profitability indicators for more than 100 businesses to assess the effects of taxation.
- Evaluated alternative impact-evaluation methodologies, focusing on quasi-experimental approaches.

Research Papers and Ongoing Projects

- The Tone of Solidarity: Race, Colorism, and Attitudes Toward Redistribution in Colombia in Times of Migration. Working paper.
- Displacement, Conflict, and Educational Trajectories in Colombia. Work in progress.
- Changing the Tax Structure to Reduce Income Inequality in Colombia: A Microsimulation Model. Published.
- Welfare Dynamics and Fiscal Policy in a Growing Economy. Work in progress.
- International Migration Outlook 2022 report (Published).
- Beta and Sigma Convergence in Latin America. Published in *Outlier*, no. 15.

Selected Presentations and Academic Activities

- Research stay at the Centre d'Économie de la Sorbonne (CES), Université Paris 1 Panthéon–Sorbonne, supported by the French Embassy in Colombia through the France Excellence High-Level Scientific Stay Scholarship (SSHN), Nov.–Dec. 2026, France.
- Presentation at the Second ECINEQ–Latin American and Caribbean Conference, Oct. 28–29, 2026, Universidad de la República, Montevideo, Uruguay.
- Presentation at the IX Colombian Economics Conference, organized by the Center for Economic Development Studies (CEDE), Oct. 1–2, 2026, Universidad de los Andes, Colombia.
- Presentation at the Javeriana–University of Alberta Economics Workshop (JAE Workshop), Jun. 2026, Canada.
- Participation in the RIDGE Summer School in Economics (RIDGE May Forum), May 18–22, 2026, University of the West Indies, Barbados.
- Presentation at the REP LAC Conference, Feb. 4, 2026, at IDB Headquarters in Washington, DC.

Awards and Fellowships

- High-Level Scientific Stay Fellowship (SSHN), French Embassy in Colombia / Centre d'Économie de la Sorbonne (CES), Université Paris 1 Panthéon–Sorbonne, 2026.
- Conditionally Forgivable Doctoral Scholarship, Pontificia Universidad Javeriana, 2025–present; and doctoral contract, KU Leuven.
- Best Paper by Young Researchers, International Microsimulation Association World Congress, 2021.

Languages, Skills, Interests

Languages: Spanish (native), English (C1, IELTS), French (C1, DALF), Italian (A1).
Software: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, MATLAB/Dynare, EViews, EUROMOD, Bloomberg, and Microsoft Office.
Interest: sports (running preparing marathon, tennis, football), cinema (the'80s), culture, social sciences, dance (salsa), music, travelling.